China had undertaken several case studies which were only now coming out in public portals. One such anecdotal study was where the researchers were studying a typical case of cluster outbreak caused by public transportation exposure. In the study, a male passenger took two bus rides. He had begun coughing on the first ride, unaware that he may have been infected with COVID-19. After the first ride, he purchased a face mask and put it on before getting on to the second ride in a minibus. The results were so telling. Five passengers out of the 39 in the first bus ride came to be infected, whereas none of the 14 passengers in the minibus were found to have contracted the infection.[18]

Another study where viral shedding was observed in a group of over 3,000 individuals noted that mask intervention significantly stratified it. Both, respiratory droplets as well as aerosols were compared between participants wearing masks and those not wearing masks. Both the above studies demonstrated a dramatic reduction in transmission when masks were worn.[19]

The prime minister, convinced by the studies and best practices put forth during a meeting on 26 March, advised the PSA to draw up guidance on how to make and use home-made face masks. Subsequently, the prime minister's close aides together with the joint secretary for health in the PMO were putting together experiences of other countries for him to look at. The prime minister requested to read some peer-reviewed papers before making a final decision on masks. After all, it was about mandating individuals to use a piece of clothing. And he wanted to be absolutely certain about its effectiveness. As his advisors frequently note, it is no easy job for a leader to accurately sift through fast-changing information and developing science and conclusively make decisions which had the potential to upset political stability. Several world leaders were facing the flack. Chinese president Xi Jinping was being criticized for his opacity, Prime Minister Boris Johnson for overreliance on scientists' advice which was not accurately presented to him and President Trump for disregarding scientific advice.

Prime Minister Modi was certain: we would have to leave aside political consequences and make difficult decisions, as long as they were backed by strong evidence-based studies. The team presented to him several aforementioned studies in addition to another one worked upon by a spectrum of respectable researchers from the University of San Francisco,